

A parent's reflection on society and the next generation

I was raised with the values of respect, **resilience** and financial **prudence** principles. yet, I sometimes **wonder** if these values still carry the same significance

I was born in a middle-class family 66 years back, less than 12 years after independence. My father was an engineer in a state government department. I **came across** my mother's diary a few years back. She had spent her life **painstakingly** balancing a low government income against the rising expenses of **bringing up** three children. My parents **inculcated** in us the value of money.

Another **value** that was deeply **ingrained** into our **psyche** by them **was** to respect everyone. I was taught that relationships were more important. **A look** of **reproach** from my mother **was** enough for me to realise my mistake if I was disrespectful.

This is what I tried to pass on to my children. I **often** look at them with pride. Having lived a better part of my life trying to **hold on** to these values, I now find myself **at crossroads**. **Rapid urbanisation** has **resulted in** concentration of bigger population in apartments.

Technology has evolved like never before to provide faster modes of communication. Society WhatsApp group is unfortunately used by a few people at the expense of **harmonious** relationships.

Recently, I found myself at the receiving end of a **vitriolic diatribe**. My fault was that I had taken the initiative of organising a cultural and literature festival.

I sincerely believe that our youngsters need more **exposure** to the arts to **navigate** an increasingly fast-paced and more stressful world than what we grew up in. The language used by a few of these persons, who have claimed to be my good friends and neighbours over the past eight years, left me **nonplussed** at best and painfully hurt at worst. It should not have surprised me. These very people have been habitually doing the same followed by **profuse** apologies as it suits them. It just seems **expedient** to them in the **murky** world of society politics. It does not matter to them if their actions are **derogatory**.

The **condominium** seems to be **mirroring** the happenings beyond the residential complex. I am left wondering that **politics and religion**, the two factors that should create a unified society, **are** used to divide.

It is **at times** like these that I start doubting the values inculcated by my parents, and that in turn, I expect my children to follow. I talked to many other residents working with me for the festival. They were also **indignant** and sad about the way things were **turning out to be**.

They had their own stories to **narrate**. One lady was rudely told to **curb** her **flair** for taking good initiative. Another lady was left with only four other friends when it was time to **pitch in**. The majority

suffers in silence at the hands of the minority. It made me rethink if our parents were wrong in turning us what many may call **timid** to suffer mental **anguish**. I also **debated** if we passed the right values to our children.

We were **unanimous** in our shared belief. I derived strength as I looked around, and talked to these parents, many of whom were younger. We have been right in teaching our children to be better humans.

Our children are better than us. They are putting the same technology to better use. #Me Too, Girls' Right to Education, Let's Talk, Good Touch Bad Touch are only a few of the initiatives that they are **pursuing** with single-minded devotion to make this a better world. I am confident that they will set better examples for the next generations to raise their voices and not suffer in silence against the **bullies**.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

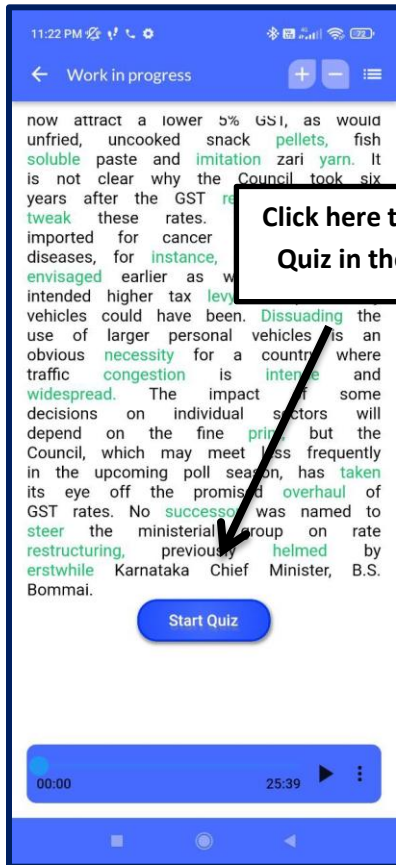
1. **Reflection** (on) (noun) – Thought, Consideration, Contemplation, Meditation, Deliberation विचार
2. **Resilience** (noun) – Endurance, Toughness, Flexibility, Strength, Fortitude मजबूती
3. **Prudence** (noun) – Wisdom, Caution, Carefulness, Judiciousness, Foresight सावधानी
4. **Wonder** (verb) – Ponder, Question, Marvel, Speculate, Reflect सोचना
5. **Come across** (phrasal verb) – Encounter, Find, Discover, Meet, Stumble upon मिलना
6. **Painstakingly** (adverb) – Carefully, Diligently, Meticulously, Thoroughly, Assiduously सावधानी से
7. **Bring up** (phrasal verb) – Raise, Rear, Nurture, Educate, Foster पालन-पोषण करना
8. **Inculcate** (verb) – Instill, Implant, Impart, Embed, Teach मन में बैठाना
9. **Ingrain** (verb) – Embed, Imprint, Instill, Fix, Root गहराई से जमाना
10. **Psyche** (noun) – Mind, Soul, Spirit, Consciousness, Inner self मन
11. **Reproach** (noun) – Blame, Criticism, Rebuke, Censure, Disapproval फटकार
12. **Often** (adverb) – Frequently, Repeatedly, Regularly, Commonly, Usually अक्सर
13. **Hold on** (phrasal verb) – Cling, Grasp, Retain, Persist, Endure पकड़े रहना
14. **At crossroads** (phrase) – At a turning point, At a critical juncture, At a decisive moment, At a pivotal point, At a crucial stage महत्वपूर्ण मोड़ पर
15. **Rapid** (adjective) – Fast, Quick, Swift, Speedy, Brisk तेज़
16. **Urbanisation** (noun) – Urban development, Urban growth, City expansion, Urban sprawl, Metropolitanization शहरीकरण
17. **Result in** (phrasal verb) – Cause, Lead to, Bring about, Produce, Trigger परिणाम होना
18. **Harmonious** (adjective) – Peaceful, Balanced, Congenial, Amicable, Friendly सामंजस्यपूर्ण
19. **Vitriolic** (adjective) – Bitter, Caustic, Acidic, Hostile, Sarcastic तीखा
20. **Diatribes** (noun) – Tirade, Harangue, Rant, Criticism, Attack आक्षेप
21. **Exposure** (noun) – Experience, Introduction, Familiarity, Awareness, Contact अनुभव
22. **Navigate** (verb) – Steer, Guide, Direct, Maneuver, Pilot मार्गदर्शन करना

23. **Nonplussed** (adjective) – Confused, Bewildered, Perplexed, Puzzled, Stunned
हक्का-बक्का
24. **Profuse** (adjective) – Abundant, Copious, Lavish, Excessive, Generous प्रचुर
25. **Expedient** (adjective) – Convenient, Practical, Advantageous, Useful, Opportunistic उपयुक्त
26. **Murky** (adjective) – Dark, Gloomy, Cloudy, Obscure, Unclear अस्पष्ट
27. **Derogatory** (adjective) – Disparaging, Insulting, Belittling, Disrespectful, Offensive अपमानजनक
28. **Condominium** (noun) – Apartment, Flat, Residence, Housing complex, Building
अपार्टमेंट
29. **Mirror** (verb) – Reflect, Imitate, Echo, Copy, Represent प्रतिबिंबित करना
30. **At times** (phrase) – Sometimes, Occasionally, Periodically, Now and then, From time to time कभी-कभी
31. **Indignant** (adjective) – Angry, Outraged, Resentful, Furious, Irate क्रोधित
32. **Turn out to be** (phrase) – Prove to be, Result in, End up as, Become, Emerge as
साबित होना
33. **Narrate** (verb) – Tell, Recount, Describe, Relate, Report वर्णन करना
34. **Curb** (verb) – Restrict, Control, Limit, Check, Suppress रोकना
35. **Flair** (noun) – Talent, Aptitude, Skill, Ability, Knack प्रतिभा
36. **Pitch in** (phrasal verb) – Contribute, Help, Assist, Join in, Participate सहयोग करना
37. **Timid** (adjective) – Shy, Bashful, Reserved, Nervous, Fearful डरपोक
38. **Anguish** (noun) – Pain, Suffering, Distress, Agony, Torment पीड़ा
39. **Debate** (verb) – Discuss, Argue, Deliberate, Dispute, Consider बहस करना
40. **Unanimous** (adjective) – Agreed, Unified, Consensual, Undisputed, Common
सर्वसम्मत
41. **Pursue** (verb) – Chase, Follow, Seek, Strive, Continue पीछा करना
42. **Bully** (noun) – Tormentor, Oppressor, Tyrant, Intimidator, Harasser धौंसिया

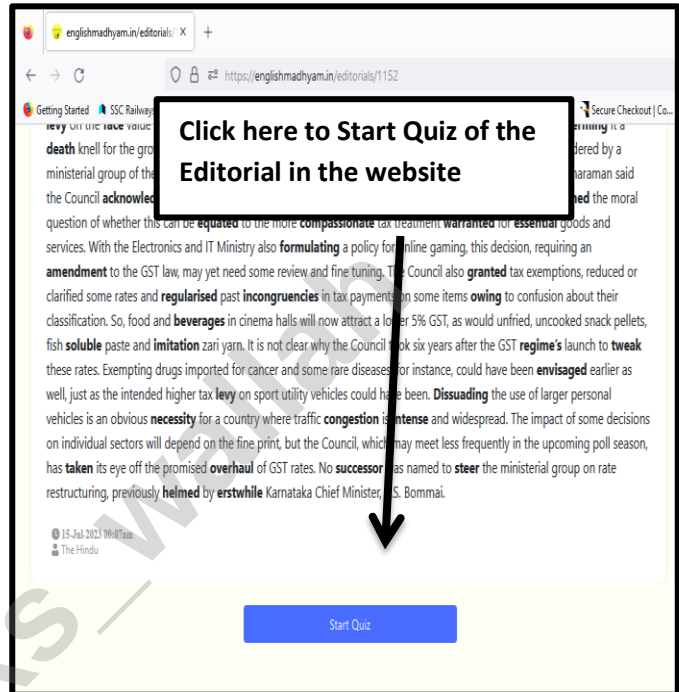
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Roots in Traditional Values:** The author was raised with values like respect, resilience, and financial prudence, which were deeply ingrained by their parents.
2. **Middle-Class Upbringing:** Born into a middle-class family post-independence, the author's parents balanced limited income with the expenses of raising three children, teaching the value of money.
3. **Importance of Respect:** Respect for everyone and prioritizing relationships were core values instilled by the author's parents.
4. **Passing on Values:** The author tried to impart these same values to their children, often feeling proud of their upbringing.
5. **Changing Societal Dynamics:** Rapid urbanization and technological advancements have transformed societal interactions, often leading to conflicts in community settings.
6. **Misuse of Technology:** Platforms like WhatsApp, intended for communication, are sometimes misused, harming harmonious relationships.
7. **Facing Criticism:** The author faced harsh criticism for organizing a cultural and literature festival, despite their good intentions.
8. **Disillusionment with Neighbors:** Long-time friends and neighbors used derogatory language, leaving the author hurt and questioning their relationships.
9. **Society Politics:** The condominium's dynamics reflect broader societal issues, where politics and religion are used to divide rather than unite.
10. **Doubts About Values:** The author began to question whether the values taught by their parents are still relevant in today's world.
11. **Shared Experiences:** Other residents shared similar stories of facing negativity and lack of support for their initiatives.
12. **Suffering in Silence:** Many endure mental anguish due to the actions of a minority, raising questions about the effectiveness of traditional values like timidity.
13. **Reaffirming Beliefs:** Despite doubts, the author and other parents reaffirmed their belief in teaching their children to be better humans.
14. **Next Generation's Progress:** The younger generation is using technology positively, leading initiatives like #MeToo, Girls' Right to Education, and awareness campaigns.
15. **Hope for the Future:** The author is confident that the next generation will set better examples, stand up against bullies, and create a more just and compassionate world.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



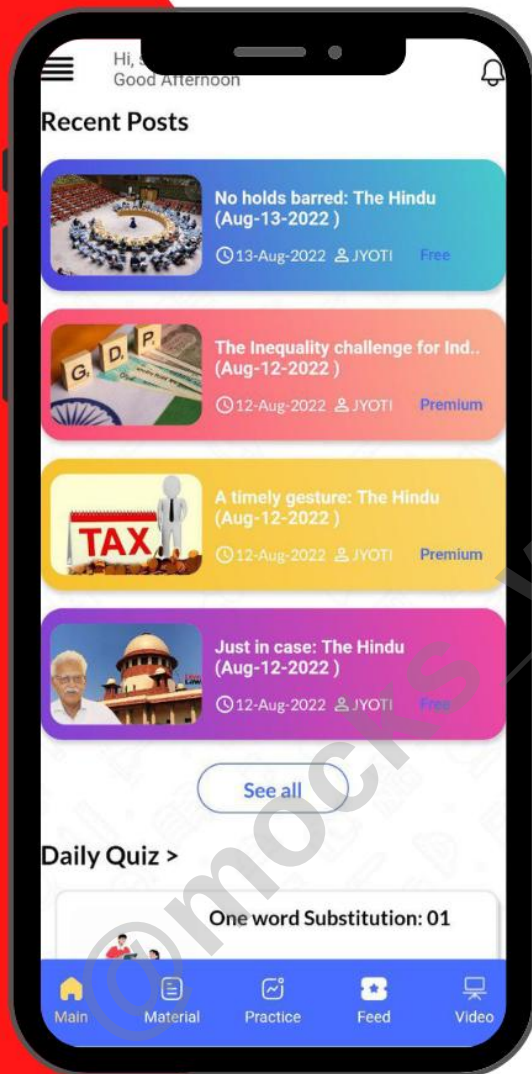
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